

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 4
♥ J 9 8 5
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ J 10

♠ A J

♥ K Q 4 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ K 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7 2

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 8 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ K 6 4

♣ A 8 7

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

[showcards W:S2 N:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠2, dummy played the ♠3

Play the ♠Q. This is a perfect example of why you should USUALLY play Third-hand-high.

If you do not put your ♠Q on this trick declarer will get an undeserved winner with his ♠J. In this Deal it will be his ninth trick. Play Third-hand-high and he will go down, otherwise he will make his contract.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 7 4

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 5 3

♣ A Q J 3

♠ 2

♥ A 8 7 6 2

♦ K 8 4

♣ 10 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 8 6 3

♥ K 3

♦ Q 10 7

♣ K 6

♠ 9 5

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 6 2

♣ 9 7 4

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

trick. If you allow declarer to win the first trick he will pull trumps and discard two red losers on dummy's ♣ and make an overtrick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥A. You dare not play low for fear declarer might win a singleton ♥K.

And when you win the first trick, (the ♥K does NOT fall), you have to decide what to do next. Do not just return the suit like a robot since it is obvious that you have no more ♥ winners and you surely won't win any ♣ tricks.

You need to switch to a ♦, and the ♦4, (low from an honor) is recommended.

Played this way you will defeat the contract by one

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

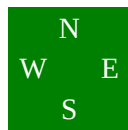
♠ J 5 3
♥ Q 10 6
♦ K 6 2
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ K 9 8

♥ A 8 5

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ 9 7 3



♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 8 7

♣ Q J 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K J 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ K 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
which would be too bad for your side.

[showcards W:C4 N:C3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣4, dummy played the ♣3

Third-hand-high is usually a good plan to follow, certainly that is true in this deal. But that doesn't mean you should blindly play your HIGHEST card, rather you should play the LOWEST of high-equals.

In other words, in this case you should play the ♣J, which is equal to the ♣Q.

If instead you play the ♣Q, figuring it makes no difference, you'd be right that it makes no difference to you. But partner would then assume that it is declarer with the ♣J, and when he obtains the lead with the ♦K he will be unlikely to lead another ♣,